- The manager focuses on systems and structure; the leader focuses on people.
- The manager relies on control; the leader inspires trust.
- The manager has a short-range view; the leader has a long-range perspective.
- The manager asks how and when; the leader asks what and why.
- The manager does things right; the leader does the right thing.
- The manager uses delegated responsibility; the leader seeks to expand responsibility.

Kokla was first and foremost a commander with many leadership qualities. He imparted to his people the insight that the first guiding principle should be to carry out the mission at any cost. The second principle is to carry it out exacting the lowest cost possible.

Kokla believed that a commander's place should be at the intersection at which he could make the most significant contribution to the carrying out of the mission. There is always the temptation to be at the tip of the spear, but as a commander he always knew how to assess the situation and, throughout a mission, to put himself in other places as well.

A true commander does not rest on the laurels of the glory of operations past and does not preserve himself for the great missions of the future. He focuses on the mission at hand.

Detailed planning, caution, and hard work were his guiding principles, and they proved to be a recipe for success. People say that God is in the details. Kokla proved that the small details are what make the difference between good and great.

Kokla believed that in every command there was still room for maneuver and discretion, which often caused me headaches and the feeling that I needed to remind him that even when he was convinced that he must stray from the command he had to take into account that there was still information that he didn't know and if he was wrong, then . . . and here he would finish my sentence, saying: "Yes, if I am wrong, the responsibility is entirely mine."

In crisis situations, or when one's back was up against the wall, Kokla would express his belief that there were no desperate situations, only